



INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT RANCHI

MBA

ACADEMIC YEAR: 2026-27

CORE COURSE

COURSE NAME: Communication-II

TERM: 2

CREDITS: 1.5

FACULTY DETAILS

Name	Faculty Office Address	Email
Neelu	#305, 3 rd Floor, Siddhu Block	neelu@iimranchi.ac.in
Rajiv Aricat	#412, 4th floor, Birsa Munda Block	rajiv.aricat@iimranchi.ac.in
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CONSULTATION TIME FOR STUDENTS:

By email appointment

COURSE DESCRIPTION

Communication-II is an advanced-level course designed to develop the strategic and managerial communication capabilities of MBA students. The course examines communication as a critical organizational resource and focuses on the design, delivery, and interpretation of messages in professional contexts. The course addresses key areas of managerial communication, including effective message design, digital and AI-mediated communication, delivery of negative messages, inclusive and authentic communication, crisis communication and public relations, business proposals, and interview communication. Emphasis is placed on clarity, tone, credibility, ethics, and inclusivity while communicating with diverse stakeholders. Through selected textbook readings, case discussions, contemporary articles, and applied classroom exercises, the course enables students to develop context-sensitive communication skills essential for leadership, decision-making, and organizational effectiveness.

COURSE OBJECTIVE

1. To develop advanced communication skills by enabling students to design, deliver, and evaluate

messages across routine, sensitive, and high-stakes organisational contexts.

2. To enhance students' ability to use authenticity, and inclusive communication to build meaningful connections and communicate effectively in professional contexts, including business writing and interviews.
3. To equip students with the competence to communicate effectively through digital, AI-mediated, and public-facing platforms, including crisis and professional career contexts.

CLO – PLT – ASSESSMENT TOOL MAPPING:

Course Learning Outcome (CLO)	Program Level Trait (PLT)	Assessment Tool(s)
CLO 1: Design clear, coherent, and context-appropriate managerial messages including routine and negative communications by applying principles of tone, audience analysis, and ethical responsibility.	Students should be able to write meaningful sentences (T6)	End Term
CLO 2: Demonstrate inclusive communication practices, and authentic leadership communication in interpersonal and organizational interactions.	Students should be able to write grammatically correct English (T4)	End Term
CLO 3: Apply advanced communication strategies in professional contexts such as digital communication, crisis and public relations messaging, business proposals, and employment interviews.	Students should be able to communicate effectively during presentation (T8)	Presentation

PRESCRIBED TEXTBOOKS:

Cardon, P. W. (2015). *Business communication: Developing leaders for a networked world*. New Delhi: McGraw-Hill Education (Indian Edition).

Monippally, M. M. (2013). *Business communication: From principles to practice*. New Delhi: McGraw-Hill Education.

ADDITIONAL READINGS:

Guffey, M. E. (2023). *Essentials of business communication* (12th ed.). Cengage Learning.

EVALUATION SCHEME:

Evaluation Components	Detail	Weightage (%)
End-term exam	The exam is closed book. Questions will be asked from topics covered in sessions 1 to 8. Students will be evaluated on their learnings of the theories and principles related to managerial	40

	communication, and their application to different scenarios.	
WAI Project	Students will be asked to work on an individual project with the help of AI. (Details given below)	25
Group Project (Presentation plus Report/PPT submission)	Students will work in groups to complete a project report and present their projects in class. The groups will work on a topic of either of their choice from a list of scenarios provided to them or as assigned by the course instructor.	25
Attendance	The students are encouraged to attend and participate in all the sessions for an in-depth understanding of the course.	10
Total		100

WAI PROJECT DETAILS: This project tests a student's ability to use AI to synthesize knowledge and solve real-world problems. Students should (i) identify a problem on topics discussed as part of the course (e.g., organizational communication, public relations, crisis communication, interpersonal communication, non-verbal communication, etc.), (ii) analyze the problem; and, (iii) propose solutions. Analysis should be done using an AI platform.

Based on the final report and the self-made video presentation, you will be evaluated both on the process of using AI, and the quality of your reflection on how solutions were achieved with imaginative uses of the AI technology.

Detailed project guidelines and submission requirements will be communicated separately.

GROUP ASSIGNMENT DETAILS: Students will work in groups to complete a project and present their projects in the class. Additionally they will also be required to submit a written report/PPTs as informed by the course instructors. They will be evaluated on the basis of their:

Content & Clarity – Clear understanding of the topic, logical flow, and ability to explain concepts effectively.

Verbal Communication – Clarity of speech, fluency, articulation, pace, voice modulation, and appropriate language.

Non-Verbal Communication – Eye contact, posture, gestures, facial expressions, confidence, and audience engagement.

Presentation Design & Delivery – Clarity and visual appeal of slides, effective use of visuals/data, time management, and overall impact.

SOFTWARE(S) USED: Nil

FIELD TRIPS / WORKSHOPS PLANNED: Nil

ACADEMIC MISCONDUCT: Please refer to the latest MBA manual provided to you.

ELEMENTS OF SOCIAL IMPACT IN COURSE CURRICULUM: This course emphasizes that effective business communication plays a critical role in shaping ethical, inclusive, and socially responsible organizational practices. It highlights how communication in contexts such as difficult conversations, crisis situations, and digital platforms can influence stakeholder trust, public perception, and societal outcomes. The course also addresses the importance of inclusivity and authenticity in engaging diverse audiences, encouraging sensitivity to cultural, social, and contextual differences. Further, it examines the ethical use of technology and AI in communication, with attention to issues such as misinformation, credibility, and accountability. By incorporating these skills, the course prepares students to communicate in ways that not only achieve organizational objectives but also contribute positively to society.

DETAILED SESSION PLAN:

Session no.	Business Problem	Topic(s) & Discussion Questions	Readings (Textbook, Articles, Cases)	Suggested additional readings
1	Leaders are often misunderstood when their communication does not account for diverse perspectives or lacks authenticity.	1) Topic: <i>Inclusive and authentic communication</i> 2) Discussion Questions What are the traits of an inclusive leader? How to communicate with authenticity ?	Textbook: Chapter 4 in P. Cardon Case: Was That Harassment? (HBR Case Study) Product #: R1903X-PDF-ENG Article: https://hbr.org/2020/11/what-inclusive-leaders-sound-like	Nil
2	Organizations face delays, errors, and misalignment because routine communication is misunderstood or ignored, leading to poor execution of tasks.	1) Topic: <i>Effective message design for routine messages</i> 2) Discussion questions: How to design routine messages that ensure clarity, alignment, and efficient action without misinterpretation? How to manage tone in writing?	Textbook: Chapter 6 in P. Cardon Case: HBR Case: When the Tone of an Email Went Wrong, Ivey case; Product ID: W16282-PDF-ENG	Nil
3	Organizations struggle with miscommunication	1) Topic: <i>Communicating with and through technology</i>	Textbook: Chapters 8, 9 and 17 in P. Cardon	Nil

	n, disengagement, and reputational risks due to ineffective use of digital and AI-mediated communication platforms.	2) Discussion questions: How to communicate effectively across digital and AI-mediated platforms while maintaining clarity, credibility, and engagement?	Article: https://hbr.org/2024/05/were-all-in-fluencers-now	
4	Poorly handled negative communication and conflicts lead to damaged relationships, reduced morale, and loss of trust within and outside the organization.	1) Topic: <i>Negative messages (Bad-news messages)</i> 2) Discussion question: How to compose effective bad-news messages in person and in writing for various audiences, including colleagues, external partners, and customers.	Textbook: Chapter 12 in P. Cardon Article: Bies, R. J. (2013). The delivery of bad news in organizations: A framework for analysis. <i>Journal of Management</i> , 39(1), 136-162.	A Better Way to Deliver Bad News https://hbr.org/2002/09/a-better-way-to-deliver-bad-news
5	What is the importance of crisis communications messages for organizations?	1) Topic: <i>Crisis communication</i> 2) Discussion questions: Discuss how crisis communications impact organizational reputation. How to construct an effective and responsible crisis response?	Articles: https://hbr.org/2023/12/corporate-crises-and-reputational-recovery-have-changed How Companies Should Weigh In on a Controversy https://hbr.org/2024/03/how-companies-should-weigh-in-on-a-controversy	Crisis Communication Do's and Don'ts https://www.harvardbusiness.org/wp-content/uploads/2022/03/Crisis-Communicaitons-Dos-and-Donts.pdf
6	What is the importance of public relations (PR) messages for organizations? (Session to be delivered by an industry expert)	1) Topic: <i>Public Relations</i> 2) Discussion questions: Discuss how public relations messages impact organizational reputation. How to construct effective and responsible public	Article: https://hbsp.harvard.edu/product/U0705D-PDF-ENG	(As suggested by the guest speaker)

	subject to availability and approval)	relations messages?		
7	Critical insights and ideas fail to influence decisions because they are communicated in a fragmented, data-heavy, and unengaging manner.	1) Topic: <i>Business Proposals and Analytical Reports</i> 2) Discussion questions: How to make your insights stick when you communicate your business proposal?	Textbook: Chapters 13 and 14 in P. Cordon	How to Write a Great Business Plan https://hbr.org/1997/07/how-to-write-a-great-business-plan
8	How can individuals strategically communicate their competencies and assess organizational fit in high-stakes interview situations?	1) Topic: <i>Interviews</i> 2) Discussion questions: How to prepare for a job interview? How to use STAR technique?	Article: 4 Ways to Make a Connection with Your Interviewer Source: Harvard Business Review Digital Article Product #: H08DHN-PDF-ENG	https://www.theguardian.com/careers/careers-blog/star-technique-competency-based-interview
9	Group presentations			
10	Group presentations			

Signed by:

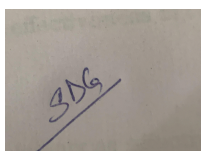
Neelu:



Rajiv Aricat:



Shilpee Dasgupta:



Chairperson, Liberal Arts & Sciences Area:

